



Department of Computer Science
COMSATS University Islamabad

CSC417 - 10

E-Commerce & Digital Marketing

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LAB 10

Lab Task 1: Responding to Customer Comments – Great Grounds Coffee

Scenario: You work for a marketing agency hired by Great Grounds, a small regional chain of coffee shops based in the Northeast United States. You are reviewing and responding to three customer comments posted on the company's Facebook profile. Each response must consider the comment type, the customer's needs, and the appropriate tone for effective social media engagement.

Completed Customer Comment Responses

Comment Type	Customer	Comment	Resources / Information	Response
Positive Feedback	Daniela Rosas	"I am SO happy that it's holiday flavor time at Great Grounds! Love, love, love your gingerbread latte! Makes me want to curl up with my drink and a good book in front of the fire."	No specific resources required.	Hi Daniela! Your comment just made our whole team smile! We are so thrilled that the gingerbread latte has a special place in your heart — there is truly nothing better than cozying up with a warm drink and a good book. Thank you for being such a wonderful part of the Great Grounds community. We look forward to seeing you soon! #GreatGrounds #HolidayFlavors
Question	Bruce Tang	"I'm trying to reduce the amount of sugar in my diet. Can you tell me which Great Grounds' drinks are low sugar or sugar-free?"	Nutritional info: www.GreatGrounds.com/NutritionalFacts	Hi Bruce! Great question — we love that you're looking out for your health! Great Grounds offers several low-sugar and sugar-free options. For a full nutritional breakdown of all beverages, check out: www.GreatGrounds.com/NutritionalFacts . You can also ask our baristas to customize your drink — sugar-free syrups, reduced sweetness, or no added sugar are all options. We're happy to help you find your perfect cup!
Negative Comment	Imani Moore	"What's up with the hike in Great Grounds' prices?! I used to be able to get my daily medium mocha for \$4. Now it's \$4.25! That's really going to add up over time . . ."	Reason: recent coffee shortage. Promo code: HALFOFF (50% off one drink).	Hi Imani, we completely understand your frustration and sincerely appreciate you sharing your feedback with us. You are right that prices have increased slightly. Like many businesses, Great Grounds has been impacted by a recent global coffee shortage, which has raised our costs. We never take pricing decisions lightly. As a thank-you for your loyalty, we would love to offer you 50% off your next beverage — just use code HALFOFF at checkout, in-store or online. We hope to see you soon!

Response Strategy Analysis

Comment Type	Strategy Applied	Key Principle
Positive Feedback (Daniela)	Acknowledge enthusiasm, mirror positive energy, reinforce brand community, use relevant hashtags.	Amplify positive sentiment — thank and celebrate loyal customers to encourage word-of-mouth and UGC.

Question (Bruce)	Provide direct resource link, offer personalized assistance, align with health-conscious brand positioning.	Educational engagement — treat the customer as a partner, not just a sales target. Builds trust.
Negative Comment (Imani)	Empathize first, explain the price increase reason (coffee shortage) without making excuses, offer concrete recovery incentive (HALFOFF code).	Service recovery — a well-handled complaint can convert a dissatisfied customer into a loyal advocate.

Reflection: Social Media Engagement Best Practices

This exercise reinforced three core principles of effective social media community management:

Tone consistency: Every response — positive, neutral, or negative — must reflect the brand's warm, inclusive voice. Consistency across interactions builds customer trust and brand recognition.

Speed and specificity: Vague, template-like responses feel automated and impersonal. Referencing the customer's specific words (e.g., "gingerbread latte," "daily medium mocha") demonstrates genuine attention and care.

Turning negatives into opportunities: The HALFOFF promo code in Imani's response illustrates how proactive recovery offers can convert a potentially brand-damaging comment into a loyalty-building moment.